

James Wedgwood

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SUMMARY

I am a second-year masters student in Machine Learning at Carnegie Mellon University, where I have been fortunate to be advised by Virginia Smith and Barnabas Poczos. My research interests include AI safety, interpretability, and alignment, as well as ML applications in science.

EDUCATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Carnegie Mellon University — *M.S. in Machine Learning*

2025 – PRESENT

4.08 GPA

Research advised by Profs. Virginia Smith and Barnabas Poczos

Selected coursework: Deep Reinforcement Learning and Control, Optimization for Machine Learning, Probabilistic Graphical Models, Advanced Introduction to Machine Learning, Intermediate Statistics

Participated in Students Using Data Science for Social Good (SUDS)

Yale University — *B.S. in Mathematics, Literature & Comparative Cultures*

2016 – 2020

3.95 GPA; *summa cum laude*; Phi Beta Kappa; distinction in both majors

Participated in Yale Student Academic Competitions (president 2018–2020, vice president 2017–2018), Yale Club Running (captain 2017–2018), Yale Climbing Team, Yale Outdoors, IES Nantes (spring 2019)

PUBLICATIONS

James Wedgwood, Pratiksha Thaker, Neil Kale & Virginia Smith. *Personalization, Personas, and Forecasting in Value Alignment* (2026)

Pluralistic Alignment Workshop, ICML 2026

James Wedgwood, Aashiq Muhamed, Mona T. Diab & Virginia Smith. *DSPA: Dynamic SAE Steering for Data-Efficient Preference Alignment* (2026)

Workshop on Representational Alignment (Re-Align), ICLR 2026

James Wedgwood, Chhavi Yadav & Virginia Smith. *Automated Concept Discovery for LLM-as-a-Judge Preference Analysis* (2026)

Workshop on Unifying Concept Representation Learning, ICLR 2026 (Oral)

James Wedgwood. *PCTYBR Inv. 708(A) and (B): A Letter from the Prefect and a Court Summons*. *Zeitschrift für Papyrologie und Epigraphik* 219, 2021, pp. 161–166

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Salesforce — *Lead Data Scientist*

FEBRUARY 2025 – APRIL 2025

Led design and development of LLM-powered chatbot apps including a text-to-SQL API and RAG service; most impactful app projected to save \$24M/year in productivity

— *Data Scientist*

AUGUST 2022 – FEBRUARY 2025

Built an end-to-end A/B testing pipeline yielding a 15X increase in Monthly Active Learners; co-developed a recommendation engine serving millions of users

— *Analyst, Strategy & Growth*

FEBRUARY 2021 – AUGUST 2022

Built out analytics and reporting program for Trailhead, a product with >500K monthly active users

Bluebonnet Data — Data Fellow; Technical Advisor

AUGUST 2020 – NOVEMBER 2024

2024: Designed and delivered **data visualization training** and provided technical guidance for fellows

2020–2021: Wrote **scripts in Python and R** to analyze and visualize data for two campaigns

TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

Yale Mathematics Department — Course Grader

2018 – 2020

Graded assignments for three undergraduate math courses: Complex Analysis, Calculus II, Linear Algebra

Akros International Prep — Tutor

2017 – 2021

Tutored long-term clients, primarily in mathematics, with boutique educational firm

SELECTED SKILLS AND AWARDS

Technologies and Languages

Python: Pytorch, Transformers, TransformerLens/SAELens, Langchain, LlamaIndex, Scikit-learn, Pandas

Other technologies: Github, AWS (Sagemaker, S3, Redshift), Docker, SQL

Languages: Spanish, French, Chinese (professional working proficiency); German (limited working proficiency); Latin, Ancient Greek (reading and writing only)

Awards

HSK Level 6 (2026), passed highest level of rigorous Chinese exam, indicating “near-native proficiency,” after three years of self-study

Alvin B. Kernan Prize (2020), for “the best senior essay in the Literature major”

E. Francis Riggs Prize (2017), given to the strongest of **100+ students** in Yale’s Directed Studies program

Mike Dodge Prize (2017), for the best philosophy essay in Yale’s Directed Studies program

International Linguistics Olympiad (2015–2016): **first place worldwide** individually (2015), **second place** (2016); Team USA **first place** (2015)

North American Computational Linguistics Olympiad (2015–2016): **first place** in US and Canada (2015), **second place** (2016)